

PIUS J. ODAWO

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Hands-on and people-focused **HR professional with over 5 years of progressive experience** in HR operations, employee relations, recruitment, performance management, workforce planning, attendance management, employee welfare and Kenyan employment-law compliance. Experienced in supporting **multi-site and operational workforces**, working closely with supervisors, managers and employees to address workplace concerns, improve employee productivity and maintain fair and consistent application of HR policies. Strong practical experience handling **grievances, disciplinary cases, workplace conflicts and employee-relations investigations**, with a focus on procedural fairness, confidentiality, documentation and compliance. Experienced in recruitment and onboarding, attendance and leave administration, performance management, workforce reporting and HR policy implementation. Brings a practical approach to translating HR policies into clear workplace expectations and supporting managers in resolving people-related challenges.

CORE SKILLS

HR Operations & Administration | Employee Relations & Grievance Handling | Disciplinary Management & Investigations | Kenyan Employment & Labour Law Compliance | Attendance, Leave & Absenteeism Management | Recruitment & Workforce Planning | Employee Onboarding & Induction | Performance Management & Improvement | Supervisor & Line Manager Support | Workplace Conflict Resolution | HR Policy Implementation | Employee Welfare & Engagement | Workforce Reporting & HR Analytics | HRIS & Employee Records Management | Payroll & Statutory Compliance | Confidential HR Case Management | Workforce Productivity & Retention | Training & Employee Development

SELECTED RELEVANT ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Led complex employee-relations investigations, disciplinary hearings and grievance-resolution processes** while maintaining confidentiality, proper documentation and compliance with Kenyan labour laws.
- Improved **recruitment efficiency by 30%** through structured recruitment processes and workforce planning.
- Supported workforce stability, with annual employee **attrition maintained below 2%**.
- Achieved **100% statutory compliance** across PAYE, NSSF, NHIF and pension obligations with zero regulatory penalties.
- Developed HR dashboards tracking **headcount, absenteeism, attrition and performance**, providing management with practical workforce insights.
- Managed operational HR activities involving **staffing, shift planning, attendance, leave, overtime, employee welfare and labour-cost management** at Jambo Jipya Tours & Travels.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

FREELANCE HR – PEOPLE & CULTURE - Kenya | January 2026 – Present

Provide practical HR advisory and organisational support to SMEs and growth-stage organisations.

- Advise management on **HR policies, Kenyan labour-law compliance, employee relations and disciplinary processes**.
- Support management in addressing employee grievances, workplace concerns and disciplinary matters.
- Develop practical HR governance frameworks aligned with organisational requirements and employment standards.
- Support workforce planning, restructuring and workforce-efficiency initiatives.
- Develop performance and accountability frameworks to strengthen employee performance.

- Implement HRIS solutions supporting employee documentation, workforce reporting and compliance tracking.
- Advise management on people-management practices, staffing requirements and organisational effectiveness.
- Support development of compensation and reward structures.

TREES FOR THE FUTURE (TREES) – KENYA - Human Resource Business Partner | July 2023 – December 2025

Provided HR leadership and operational support across **multi-county field operations**, partnering with managers and regional leadership on workforce matters.

- Maintained a visible HR partnership with managers and employees, providing practical guidance on workplace and employee-relations matters.
- **Led employee-relations investigations, disciplinary hearings and grievance-resolution processes** in compliance with Kenyan labour laws.
- Advised managers and employees on HR policies, workplace conduct, employee concerns and appropriate resolution processes.
- Supported fair, consistent and well-documented handling of sensitive employee-relations cases.
- Partnered with management to address employee concerns and workplace conflicts while maintaining confidentiality.
- Supported workforce planning through analysis of **headcount, absenteeism, attrition and performance trends**.
- Oversaw statutory payroll compliance covering PAYE, NSSF, NHIF and pension obligations.
- Supported implementation and standardisation of HR policies and processes across East African operations.
- Strengthened collaboration between local employees and expatriate/regional leadership within a matrix environment.
- Contributed to organisational development and change-management initiatives.

TREES FOR THE FUTURE (TREES) – KENYA -Human Resources Specialist | July 2021 – June 2023

- Managed employee lifecycle activities covering **recruitment, onboarding, employee engagement and retention**.
- Supported employee-relations matters and implementation of HR policies.
- Supported structured recruitment and workforce planning, contributing to a **30% improvement in talent-acquisition efficiency**.
- Supported employee retention initiatives, contributing to annual attrition remaining **below 2%**.
- Implemented employee wellness and wellbeing initiatives.
- Strengthened HRIS data governance, employee documentation and reporting accuracy.
- Supported HR analytics and workforce reporting for management decision-making.
- Strengthened HR compliance systems, contributing to litigation and regulatory exposure remaining below 1%.

JAMBO JIPYA TOURS & TRAVELS LTD – KENYA -HR & Admin Officer | May 2018 – March 2020

- Led day-to-day HR operations, workforce planning, recruitment, onboarding, employee relations and staff welfare.
- Managed **employee grievances, disciplinary processes, performance management and workplace conflict resolution**.
- Coordinated **staffing, shift planning, leave, attendance, overtime and labour-cost management**.

- Worked closely with departmental heads to address workforce challenges and improve employee productivity.
- Monitored operational performance across **Front Office, Housekeeping, Food & Beverage, Kitchen, Maintenance and other departments.**
- Coordinated staff training, employee engagement, retention, recognition and development initiatives.
- Ensured compliance with employment legislation, HR policies, health and safety requirements and statutory obligations.
- Prepared HR and operational reports covering **headcount, turnover, absenteeism, labour costs, performance and employee relations.**
- Advised senior management on people, operational, compliance and organisational-effectiveness matters.
- Coordinated workplace administration, facilities, vendors, supplies and other day-to-day operational requirements.

KENYA MEDICAL RESEARCH INSTITUTE (KEMRI) – KENYA - One Health Program Administrative Officer | April 2011 – April 2018

- Supported HR and administrative operations within a donor-funded research environment.
- Supported recruitment, onboarding and HR policy interpretation.
- Maintained confidential employee and consultant documentation.
- Supported payroll inputs and performance-management processes.
- Strengthened HR documentation, governance and regulatory-compliance controls.
- Coordinated administrative, procurement, budgeting and operational activities.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Graduate Level Certificate (GLC), Global Program Management and Leadership – University of Washington | 2012
- Bachelor of Human Resource Management – Makerere University, Uganda | 2009
- Certificate in Monitoring and Evaluation – AMREF Training Centre | 2012
- Member, Institute of Human Resource Management (IHRM), Kenya – In Good Standing

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Microsoft Excel, Word & PowerPoint | HRIS Administration & Implementation | ERP Systems | HR Analytics & Workforce Reporting | Payroll & Statutory Compliance | Employee Records & Documentation | Workforce Metrics | Performance Reporting | Compliance Tracking

LANGUAGES

English – Fluent | Swahili – Fluent

REFERENCES

Available upon request.